March 2026

The Honorable Chris Coons
218 Russell Senate Office Building
Washington, DC 20510
Phone: (202) 224-5042

Dear Senator Coons,

You have been one of the Senate's most consistent champions of national service and civic renewal — and you have done so with the rare ability to bring Republicans to the table alongside Democrats. That bipartisan instinct is exactly what the National Experiential Civic Education Framework requires, and exactly why I am writing to you first among Senate Democrats.

NECEF proposes structured, school-based civic programming — community service, emergency preparedness, infrastructure stewardship, and leadership development — built on existing AmeriCorps, FEMA, and Title IV infrastructure. It is the national scaling of what you have already been arguing for. The white paper includes a full cost framework ($57-$87 per student annually), a proven program model roster, and a rigorous outcome measurement system.

The political moment is real. The framework's state flexibility provisions and its grounding in existing federal programs give it genuine conservative appeal. With the right Republican co-sponsor, this can move. I believe you are the right Democrat to help identify and secure that partnership.

I am asking you to review the enclosed white paper and consider formally co-sponsoring this framework — and to help identify the right Republican partner to stand beside you at the launch. Your history of exactly that kind of coalition-building makes you uniquely positioned to make this happen.

With deep respect,

Gina Aulabaugh